



TIPS & TRICKS



Monitoring multiple log files in real-time on UNIX

In case I want to monitor two log files 'logfile' and 'logfile1' simultaneously, I use the *tail* command as follows:

```
# tail -f logfile logfile1
```

```
=> logfile <==
```

```
hi
```

```
=> logfile1 <==
```

```
SELinux Disabled at runtime
```

So you can see that dynamic updates to these log files can easily be monitored through the *tail* command.

— Munish Kumar, munishtotech@gmail.com



A simple hack enabling you to read a manual on an e-reader

Here is a tip to create an e-reader friendly help file from any specific Linux manual page with minimal effort. Let's use the e-book converter Calibre on a Linux desktop to do the conversion. Ubuntu, Debian or Mint users can enter the following command in the terminal and allow the installation to proceed.

```
sudo apt-get install calibre calibre-bin groff
```

Readers using Fedora, Red Hat or CentOS can enter the following line instead of the above option.

```
su -c "yum install calibre groff"
```

Now issue the following command at the default

terminal, almost irrespective of the distro you are using:

```
export BROWSER=calibre
```

Let us say you want the manual for the 'mount' command. Check that the manual exists, and then go create the e-book using the following two steps respectively, hitting 'q' to exit the first command in case of success.

```
man mount
```

```
man -H mount
```

This will open the manual as an e-book in Calibre. Right-click the title MOUNT within Calibre and choose *Convert books* → *Convert individually*.

Set the output to your e-reader's native format and press OK. While you watch the bottom-right corner for the conversion status, connect your Kindle or iPad via a USB cable. Once complete, right-click the title MOUNT once again within Calibre and choose *Send to device*.

Congratulations. You are ready to read the manual on your e-reader!

— A. Datta, webmaster@aucklandwhich.org



Build a broadcast terminal using the 'script' command

We can perform tele-cooperation by combining the 'script' and 'mkfifo' commands. Both these commands are simple and present, by default, on all GNU/Linux distributions. Let us quickly go through the simple steps:

- 1) Open two new terminals.
- 2) Create a named pipe in the first terminal and execute the 'script' command with the flush option as follows:

```
[bash]$ mkfifo telecooperation.fifo
```

```
[bash]$ script -f telecooperation.fifo
```